

WITH CHRIST AT THE CENTER

Weekly Marriage Check-In

GUIDE

PURPOSE

Create a consistent, protected time to coordinate life, strengthen connection, address concerns early, and support one another in marriage—with Christ at the center.

"Be completely humble and gentle; be patient, bearing with one another in love."

EPHESIANS 4:2

ONCE EACH WEEK

45–60 MINUTES

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Establish the *Rhythm*

FREQUENCY

Once

each week

LENGTH

45–60

minutes

A MONTH OF CHECK-INS

Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Final week
45–60 min	45–60 min	45–60 min	+ 20–30 min

MONTHLY ADD-ON

During the final check-in of each month, add 20–30 minutes for broader planning and goals.

SETTING

Choose a private, calm location where both spouses can focus. Keep phones away except when needed for scheduling; avoid multitasking.

PRIORITY

Protect this time unless a genuine emergency arises.

HOW WE TALK

Ground *Rules*

1. Approach the conversation as partners, not opponents. You are on the same team.
2. Listen fully before responding; seek understanding before offering solutions.
3. Use “I” statements: “I felt overwhelmed when…” rather than “You always…”
4. Speak honestly, gently, and respectfully. Do not interrupt, mock, threaten, criticize, or use resolved issues as weapons.
5. Do not ambush one another or relitigate old conflicts.
6. Communicate expectations, needs, and desires clearly.
7. If discussion becomes heated, pause, pray, and agree on a time to return to it.
8. End with clear next steps, appreciation, and prayer.



“Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry.”

JAMES 1:19

YOUR HOUR TOGETHER

Weekly *Agenda*



1	Open in Prayer	2–5 min
2	Reconnect, Encourage, and Share	10 min
3	Personal, Emotional, and Spiritual Check-In	10 min
4	Address Concerns and Repair Tensions Early	10–15 min
5	Coordinate the Week Ahead	10–15 min
6	Invest in Your Marriage	5 min
7	Close With Appreciation, Commitment, and Prayer	3–5 min

Monthly Planning Add-On — on the final check-in of each month, add 20–30 minutes.

STEP 1 OF 7 · 2–5 MINUTES

1 Open in Prayer

Begin by inviting God into the conversation.

SAMPLE PRAYER

Lord, thank You for our marriage and for the gift of one another. Give us humility, patience, honesty, and grace. Help us listen well, speak with love, forgive quickly, and work together as one. Strengthen our commitment to You and to each other. In Jesus' name, amen.

STEP 2 OF 7 · 10 MINUTES

2 Reconnect, Encourage, and Share

Slow down and reconnect before discussing tasks or concerns.

TAKE TURNS ANSWERING

1. What was one good or encouraging part of your week?
2. What was difficult, draining, or discouraging?
3. What is one thing you appreciated about me this week?
4. When did you feel most supported or connected to me?
5. What did I do—big or small—that helped, encouraged, or made you feel loved?
6. Is there anything you wish I understood better?
7. What is one way I can pray for you this week?

✧ PRACTICE

Give specific encouragement without attaching criticism to the compliment.



"Therefore encourage one another and build each other up."

1 THESSALONIANS 5:11

STEP 3 OF 7 · 10 MINUTES

3 Personal, Emotional, and Spiritual Check-In

Make room for each spouse's inner life—not just schedules and responsibilities.

QUESTIONS

1. How are you doing spiritually, emotionally, physically, and mentally?
2. What is causing stress, worry, grief, uncertainty, or discouragement?
3. What responsibility feels especially heavy right now?
4. What are you looking forward to or hoping for?
5. Is there something I may not be seeing or understanding about your week?
6. What do you need most from me: prayer, listening, practical help, affection, space, encouragement, or help solving a problem?
7. Do you need me mainly to listen, help problem-solve, or simply be present?

LISTENING RESPONSE

Before giving advice, summarize what you heard: "*What I hear you saying is...*" Then ask whether you understood correctly.



"Carry each other's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

GALATIANS 6:2

STEP 4 OF 7 · 10–15 MINUTES

4 Address Concerns and Repair Tensions Early

Use this time for hurt feelings, unresolved tension, recurring concerns, or misunderstandings. Focus on one or two issues rather than trying to solve everything at once.

DISCUSSION FRAMEWORK

1. **What happened?**
   State observable facts without exaggeration.
2. **How did it affect me?**
   Share feelings and needs honestly.
3. **What do I need or hope for?**
   Make a clear, reasonable request.
4. **What can we agree to do differently?**
   Identify one specific next step.

WHEN YOU HAVE CAUSED HURT

1. Acknowledge it without excuses.
2. Apologize specifically.
3. Ask for forgiveness.
4. Discuss what reconciliation and changed behavior will look like.

10–15 MINUTES

Address Concerns and Repair Tensions Early

HELPFUL LANGUAGE

> *I want to share this because I value our relationship, not because I want to blame you.*

> *When ——— happened, I felt ———. What I need is ———.*

> *Help me understand how you experienced that.*

> *What would repair look like to you?*

> *I am sorry for ———. Will you please forgive me?*

> *Can we agree on one next step and revisit it next week?*

> *We are on the same team.*



"Do not let the sun go down while you are still angry."

EPHESIANS 4:26

STEP 5 OF 7 10–15 MINUTES

5 Coordinate the Week Ahead

Review calendars together so neither spouse is surprised by major commitments, stress points, or family needs.

DISCUSS

- Work requirements, school obligations, travel, appointments, and deadlines
- Children's activities, transportation, childcare, and family commitments
- Household tasks, repairs, errands, and administrative needs
- Meals, exercise, rest, personal time, hobbies, and friendships
- Social events, church activities, and extended-family obligations
- Upcoming bills, purchases, savings goals, and financial decisions
- Events or commitments that may create pressure on the family schedule
- A protected date night or intentional connection time

10–15 MINUTES

Coordinate the Week Ahead

QUESTIONS

1. What does your week look like, and where are the pressure points?
2. What commitments do we need to coordinate?
3. What needs to be done at home, and who will take responsibility?
4. Is either of us carrying an unequal or unsustainable load?
5. What can we postpone, delegate, simplify, outsource, or decline?
6. What support would help you most?
7. What would help this week feel more peaceful, connected, and manageable?

END WITH CLEAR AGREEMENTS

- Who will do what?
- By when?
- What requires follow-up next week?
- When will you set aside intentional couple time?



"Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor."

ECCLESIASTES 4:9

STEP 6 OF 7 · 5 MINUTES

6 Invest in Your Marriage

Choose one intentional action that will strengthen connection in the coming week.

IDEAS

- Schedule a date, walk, coffee time, or at-home dinner.
- Pray together before bed on two nights.
- Read and discuss a short passage of Scripture.
- Write a note of encouragement.
- Initiate affection in a way your spouse values.
- Do one task that lightens your spouse's burden.
- Ask one meaningful question each day.
- Plan a shared activity that brings joy or rest.

QUESTION

"What is one concrete way we can pursue one another this week?"

"Above all, clothe yourselves with love, which binds us all together in perfect harmony."

COLOSSIANS 3:14

STEP 7 OF 7 · 3–5 MINUTES

7 Close With Appreciation, Commitment, and Prayer

CLOSE BY SHARING

- One thing I appreciate about you this week.
- One way I will better love or serve you this week.
- One commitment each of us will make before the next check-in.
- What you should pray about together.

CLOSING COMMITMENT

"We choose to pursue unity, speak with grace, forgive quickly, and serve one another in love this week."

PRAYER FOCUS

- Give thanks for one another.
- Ask for wisdom, patience, protection, unity, and grace.
- Pray for specific burdens, responsibilities, and hopes.
- Ask for help speaking truth in love and extending forgiveness.



"Let all that you do be done in love."

1 CORINTHIANS 16:14

FINAL CHECK-IN OF THE MONTH + 20–30 MINUTES

Monthly Planning *Add-On*

During the final weekly check-in of the month, add 20–30 minutes to review the next 30–60 days.

Calendar and Priorities

1. What major events, deadlines, trips, celebrations, or obligations are coming up?
2. What family, work, ministry, or personal priorities need attention?
3. What should we plan now to reduce future stress?
4. Are we overcommitted? What can we reduce, delay, delegate, or decline?

Marriage and Family Goals

1. What is one goal for our marriage this month?
2. What is one family or parenting goal?
3. What individual goal does each spouse want support in pursuing?
4. How will we protect time for rest, friendship, recreation, and connection?
5. Should we schedule a date night, day trip, shared activity, or time away?
6. How can our marriage better reflect Christ's love, grace, service, and faithfulness?

Household and Finances

1. What large expenses or financial decisions are expected this month?
2. Are we on track with savings, debt reduction, giving, or other goals?
3. What home, vehicle, school, medical, or administrative needs should be planned?
4. Which tasks should be divided, outsourced, or completed together?

Relationship Health

1. What helped us feel close this month?
2. What made connection difficult?
3. Is there a recurring conflict or communication pattern we should address?
4. What would help each spouse feel more loved, respected, secure, desired, or supported?
5. Would support from a trusted pastor, mentor couple, or qualified counselor be helpful?



FILL IN EACH WEEK

Weekly Check-In *Template*

Tap any line to type, or print and write.

DATE _____ TIME / LOCATION _____ NEXT CHECK-IN _____

1 Gratitude and Connection

This week's high point: _____

This week's challenge: _____

One thing I appreciated about you: _____

One way I felt connected to you: _____

Prayer request for this week: _____

2 Personal Check-In

Current joys, stresses, burdens, or hopes:

What I need from you this week:

3 Concerns or Repairs Needed

Issue discussed: _____

What each person heard and understood:

Agreed repair step or next action:

4 Week Ahead

Major events, deadlines, or appointments:

Family or children's needs:

Household, financial, or logistical items:

Spouse 1 will: _____

Spouse 2 will: _____

Tasks to complete together: _____

Support needed from each other: _____

5 Marriage Investment

Intentional connection plan: _____

Date/quality-time scheduled for: _____

6 Commitments and Prayer

Spouse 1 commitment before next check-in: _____

Spouse 2 commitment before next check-in: _____

What we prayed for: _____